

gram that runs Windows software. You could also play some Windows games on Linux and Mac systems provided they don't demand too much processing power or higher graphics.

Virtual Machine Software

There are many virtual machine software out there available for all the platforms Windows, Mac and Linux. We'll take a look into some of the popular ones.

VirtualBox: VirtualBox is the most popular desktop virtualization software available. It is open-source and completely free, and has active development going on with frequent updates. It is best used for virtualizing desktop environments, and it also has support for server virtualization, but it isn't preferred since it lacks centralized management. VirtualBox can be upgraded to a paid version where it would include enterprise-level features, but the free version includes all the necessary features required to virtualize a basic desktop environment. Features like Snapshot and Shared Folders are quite popular in VirtualBox and supports multi-screen resolutions. Playing games on VirtualBox won't be advised since it is best at handling non-GPU tasks.

VirtualBox also has a portable version that lets you create a virtual machine on a USB stick or external hard drive and use it on any system. With it, you don't need to install and configure any virtual machine software, you can straight away plug in your Portable VirtualBox and use the virtual machine right away.

It needs a minimum of 512 MB of RAM and runs on both 32-bit and 64-bit versions of Windows Vista, 7, 8, 8.1 and 32-bit Windows XP as well. VirtualBox is available for Mac OS X 10.6 and above



VirtualBox is a free and open source virtualization tool